

GRAMMAR

1. Parts of Speech

Every word in a sentence has an important role. It helps to make the meaning complete. In fact, even punctuation, (like a pause or intonation in oral form) plays a key role in right communication in the written format. We know that sentences, clauses and phrases are made of words. According to their nature and function, words are classified into *eight* classes. They are called **PARTS OF SPEECH**. They are: Noun, Pronoun, Verb, Adjective, Preposition, Adverb, Conjunction and Interjection.

NOUN: It is a naming word.

NOUN may be defined as the name of a person, place, thing or quality. A 'thing' we mean something that can be seen and touched (concrete). It may be something that can only be thought of and not seen and touched (abstract).

- Example:
1. *Gandhiji* is the *Father* of the *Nation*.
 2. *Gopal* saw a *bird* in the *park*.
 3. *Money* is the *root* of all *evil*.
 4. *India* is the biggest *democracy* in the *world*.

Exercise:

Read the following paragraph and identify the nouns:

Buddha's real name was Gouthama. He was the son of Suddhodana, the King of Northern India. Buddha was born 500 years before Christ was born. He preached a religion called Buddhism. Though Hinduism is older than Buddhism, it was losing its significance by the time Buddha came. Many Indians were growing dissatisfied with Hinduism. Buddha thought that the world was beautiful and everybody was happy until he came into contact with reality. One day he went into the city in his chariot and saw for the first time in his life an old man, a sick man and a dead man. Terribly shocked by the sorrow in the society, he renounced the world, and later became a great saint.

2. PRONOUN:

A PRONOUN is a word used in the place of a noun.

Example: 1. Hari said that *he* was a good swimmer.

2. When the boy hit the dog, it bit *him* with its sharp teeth.

3. Mary told *her* parents that *they* should not force *her*.

Exercise:

Fill in the blanks with suitable pronouns:

1. Between you and _____ (I/me) he is a liar.
2. Let _____ (he/him) who can, save her from drowning.
3. The boy _____ (who/whom) fell off his bicycle has hurt his leg.
4. I have not seen the girl _____ (whose/whom) suitcase was stolen.
5. Seema is the maid _____ (who/whom) I have employed.

3. VERB:

A VERB is a word which describes an action, a state, a process or experience. A verb refers to an action or a condition of the subject.

Example: 1. The thief *jumped* over the wall.

2. The sun *sets* in the West.
3. Birds *fly* in the air.
4. This year the summer *is* very hot.
5. He *gave* me a book.
6. Abdul Kalam *has become* the President of India.
7. Bees *make* honey.

Exercise:

Fill in the blanks with suitable verb:

1. Have you _____ the baby? (see/seen)
2. Hannah Montana _____ so well. (sing/sung)
3. The bird _____ away from the cage. (flew/flohn)
4. I _____ a letter for my friend. (write/wrote)
5. The friends _____ back from the trip. (drove/drove)

4. ADJECTIVE:

Adjectives modify or describe nouns and pronouns. They can be used attributively (occurring before noun) or predicatively (occurring after a form of 'be').

Example: Ashok was a **great** king. (Attributive Adjective)

He was **great**. (Predicative Adjective)

An ADJECTIVE is a word which adds something to the meaning of a noun.

Example: 1. He was a *fluent* speaker.

2. I have *many* friends in *this* town.
3. Sarala is *clever* and *industrious*.
4. Venu is a *tall* boy.
5. She is *weak* and *lean*.

Exercise:

Read the following passage and underline the adjectives.

The Deccan is a rocky-land in India. It is covered with mountains and rivers running towards the east across the Deccan into the Bay of Bengal. During the rainy season these rivers are like raging torrents; but through winter and by summer they gradually dry-up.

Farming in the Deccan is hard work, for the soil is not very rich, and hardly anything will grow without irrigation, every one grows vegetables and a little rice. The sugarcane is a good crop because the local sugar factory a few miles away will give a good price for it. Every farmer will take some of his crops to the village sugar maker to make hard brown sugar. The sweet sap is crushed out of the canes and boiled for hours in a huge iron pot until it is like coffee. Then the syrup is poured into clay jars or holes in the ground to cool.

5. ADVERB:

Adverbs modify or describe a verb, adjective, or another adverb.

Example: Lata sang **melodiously**. (Modifies a verb)

Punit was **extremely** talented. (Modifies an adjective)

They read the letter **quite** clearly. (Modifies another adverb)

An ADVERB is a word which adds something to the meaning of a verb, adjective or another adverb.

Example: 1. Copy this out *carefully*.

2. These shoes are *too* big for me.
3. He ran *very fast*.
4. The guest spoke *eloquently* at the meeting.
5. She is *very* beautiful.

Exercise:

Choose the correct Adverb or adjective from the brackets.

1. Peacock is a _____ bird. (*love/lovely*)
2. The cave was _____ and cold. (*dark/darkly*)
3. Vinesh Pogat's overweight proved _____ for her. (*cost/costly*)
4. It is _____ to think that we know everything. (*fool/foolish*)
5. The father waited _____ outside the ICU. (*nervous/nervously*)
6. It was a _____ trip to Goa. (*memorable/memorably*)
7. Hasina made a _____ decision to fly away from her homeland. (*crucial/crucially*)
8. The ancient temples are built _____. (*artistic/artistically*)
9. As usual, Tenali Ram came _____ to the court. (*late/lately*)
10. Shivaji fought _____ against Afzal Khan. (*brave/bravely*)
11. Sharm managed _____ in the competition. (*skillfully/skillful*)
12. Reena was _____ right in her answer. (*part/partly*)
13. People living near the sea should be _____. (*careful/carefully*)
14. The invaders killed the innocent people _____. (*merciless/mercilessly*)
15. Subhas prepared _____ for the IAS exam. (*good/well*)
16. Shashi Tharoor speaks English _____. (*fluently/fluently*)
17. Indian cricket team has many _____ all-rounders. (*well/good*)
18. The history of man is very _____. (*interesting/interestingly*)

19. Phoenix is a _____ mythological bird. (*strangely/strange*)
20. Dr. Gururaj Karjagi is a _____ motivational speaker. (*brilliant/brilliantly*)

21. The driver stopped the bus _____. (*abrupt/abruptly*)
22. Niraj Chopra's _____ effort was fruitful. (*hard/hardly*)
23. She dressed _____. (*quick/quickly*)
24. Lord Krishna was very _____ with Sudharma. (*friend/friendly*)
25. The teacher looked _____ at me when I came late. (*angry/angrily*)
26. Manu Bhaker is _____ to win the Olympic Medal. (*happy/happily*)
27. The music is too _____. Please turn it down! (*loud/loudly*)
28. I feel _____ that Vinesh Pogat was disqualified. (*bad/badly*)
29. My friends tell me that I sing _____. (*bad/badly*)
30. The thief stole the money _____ and ran away. (*quiet/quietly*)

PREPOSITION:

A PREPOSITION is a word usually placed before a noun or pronoun. It shows its relation with another word in a sentence.

Example: 1. The book is *on* the table.

2. The travellers sat *under* the tree.
3. I put it *in* the box.
4. The cat jumped *off* the wall.
5. The teacher is angry *with* me.

Kinds of Prepositions

- **Simple Prepositions:** *at, by, for, from, in, of, off, on, out, through, till, to, up, with, across, along, amidst, among, amongst, around, before, behind, below, between, beyond, underneath, within, without* etc.

- **Phrasal Prepositions:** *according to, ahead of, apart from, because of, due to, owing to, prior to, by means of, in addition to, in case of, in front of, in spite of, on behalf of, with regard to, with respect to, in accordance with, on account of* etc.

At:*At* expresses

1. Exactness of time or place:

She sat *at the table*.

They will come at 9'o clock.

2. Position in which anything remains or stands.

He stood *at the head of the queue*.

3. Mode of occupation, concerned with, engaged in:

They are *at work*.

What are you *at*? (What are you doing?)

4. State or condition:

The two countries are *at peace*.

5. Direction:

All of them rushed *at him*.

6. Manner in which a thing is done:

The horse dashed away *at a gallop*.

7. Origin, source, from:

I got my information *at his hands*.

8. Price, amount, number:

He buys them *at two rupees a dozen* and sells them *at three rupees each*.

9. *At* is also used in expression such as: at close quarters; at loggerheads at dawn; at a sitting; at a pinch; at sea; at last, at least.

By*By* expresses:

1. Nearness in place:

come and sit *by me*.

2. direction, position:

We came *by (through)* the fields, not *by* the main road.

3. time:

I must be home *by ten* (before).
I don't like to travel *by night* (during).

4. agency, instrumentality, means:

Machines are driven *by steam*.

This novel is *by Dickens*.

5. mode, manners or method of an action or process:

He took her *by the hand*.
Please let me know *by letter*.

6. in accordance with, in agreement with:

Don't judge a person *by his clothes*,
through the help or *by the authority*:

7. I swear *by Almighty God* that I will speak the truth.

8. according to measurement, number, quantity:

He eats apples *by the dozen*.

He drank his tea sip *by sip*.

9. *by* is used in idiomatic expressions such as: *by all means*; *by no means*; *by heart*.

For*For* expresses:

1. benefit, advantage, favour, suitability or the reverse:

Exercise is good *for the health*.

Smoking is bad *for your throat*.

2. end, purpose, aim intention:

He came *for dinner*.

He went *for a walk*.

3. wish, desire, expectation:

He has hunger *for knowledge*.

He is eager *for news*.

4. cause, reason:

He was punished *for* stealing.

5. duration of time, or distance, sum price:

She stayed *for* three weeks.

I bought it *for* twenty rupees.

6. direction, destination:

He is leaving *for* England.

We must start *for* home.

7. exchange, penalty, reward:

He is praised *for* good behaviour.

8. in spite of, instead of, in favour of:

For all his learning, he is rather stupid.

This big box will serve us better.

Some people were *for* the war and others were *against* it.

From:

From expresses:

1. motion or rest apart *from* anything:

He went *from* home.

He saved the child *from* falling.

2. rest, apart, exclusion, Prohibition:

They were cut off *from* civilization.

I will prevent you *from* doing that.

3. point of departure, origin, source:

He comes *from* London.

He speaks *from* experience.

4. difference, distinction:

I don't know him *from* Adam.

5. reason, cause, motive:

He is weak *from* hunger.

She is suffering *from* influenza.

6. inference: *From* all we hear he is mad.

In expresses rest with in an enclosed space or a specified area:

a) space: He is not *in* the house.

b) time: I will be back *in* an hour's time.

c) state, manner: I saw her *in* tears.

d) point of reference: I found a true friend *in* him.

Into

Into expresses motion *from* outside to inside:

1. space: One stream flows *into* another.

2. time: He slept late *into* the day.

3. state: Water may change *into* ice.

peculiarities in the Use of prepositions:

At, In: *At* relates to a small extent of space or time; *In* to a wider extent:

It happened *at* 8 o'clock.

He will start *at* seven o'clock *in* the morning.

1. He lives *at* Prakashnagar.

She lives *in* Bombay, *in* Hyderabad, *in* Calcutta.

2. *With, by:* *With* relates to the instrument employed for doing anything; *by* to the agent or doer.

He killed him *with* a sword.

He was killed *by* a madman.

3. *In, into at, to:* If the preposition of rest is 'in' the corresponding preposition of motion is to.

I stayed *in* the house.

I went *into* the house.

He is *at* school.

He goes *to* school.

4. *After, in:* In relation to a past space of time we use *after*, in *she died after* (= at the close of) a few days (past).

She will die *in* a few days (future).

5. *Between, among:* Between: in the middle of two. Among: In the middle of more than two.

Those two women quarrelled *between* themselves.

These three women quarrelled *among* themselves.

6. *Beside:* By the side of, outside of.

He sat *beside* me.

Your answer is *beside* (outside of, irrelevant to) the question.

- Besides:* in addition to -

Besides being sent to prison, he was fined.

7. *From, since:* Both these words denote *from* a certain point of time, *but from* can be used with *any tense* whereas *since* is used with the Perfect tenses only:

He begins (will begin, began) work *from* Monday.

He has worked *since* Monday.

He has been working *since* Monday.

8. *Till - to:*

Till is used of time: *to* is used of place; We waited *till* 10 o'clock.

He gambled *till* he had lost all his money.

He is going *to* Hyderabad tomorrow.

9. *Since, for, before, until:* *Since* is used with a point of time, *For* is used with a period of time:

I have not seen him *since Friday*.

I have not seen him *for* four days.

Before is used with a point of time:

I cannot come *before* 8 o'clock.

Until is also used with a point of time.

The holiday lasts *until* September (upto the time when).

10. *At, about, by, in, within:*

I must be home at 7 o'clock (neither earlier nor later).

I must be home *about* 7 o'clock (a little before or a later).

I must be home *by* 7 o'clock (a little before or a little after).

We will leave *in* a month (after a month has passed).

We will leave within a fortnight, (during the period).

Exercises:

- A. Insert the correct prepositions:

1. He worked.....an hour.

2. They went home.....tram.

3. The train starts.....7 o'clock.

4. We met.....a fine morning.....June.

5. He killed the snake.....a stick.

6. What are you looking.....?

7. He is very fond.....sweets.

8. We have not seen him.....Monday.

9. The poor fellow died.....fever.

10. It is difficult to live.....writing.

- B. Insert one of the prepositions given in brackets:

1. He will come.....a week (after, in).

2. If you are at home.....seven o'clock, it is early enough (at, by).

3. Don't look.....me like that (at, on).

two weeks (since, for).

4. He has not written..... her (beside, besides).
5. He is scared..... might (in, at).
6. He came..... a cold winter morning (in, on).
7. She came..... the room (to, into).
8. Let us go..... Krishna and Ravi (between, among).
9. You may sit..... all those girls (between, among).
10. He doesn't want to sit.....

C. Fill in the blanks with suitable prepositions:

1. The lawyer acquainted the client..... the facts.....
- the case..... Hindi?
2. Can you translate English..... the major nations of the world.
3. There is no agreement..... nuclear weapons regarding the ban..... stealing a watch.
4. The servant is accused..... action.
5. The army is ready..... the sea.
6. There is a guesthouse..... rats.
7. The godown is infested..... hearing, questioning him..... detail has become a problem.
- 8..... the prisoner is hard.....
9. We all live..... the same roof.
10. The land was ploughed..... the farmer..... the help of a tractor.
11. She presented me a very expensive pen..... my birth day.
12. It is very difficult to live..... curating.
13. The thief jumped..... the wall.
14. There is a temple..... the hill.
15. She is good..... painting, but exerts..... dancing.

D. Insert the appropriate prepositions or articles in the blanks.

..... daily cycle ride just 20 minutes is sufficient achieve this target. Do you know that just 20 minutes of daily cycling can almost half your risk dying from heart related disease? Amar Singal, Senior Interventional Cardiologist Sri Balaji Action Medical Institute, New Delhi, highlights several studies suggesting same. A study conducted by Purdue University concluded that regular cycling can cut your risk of heart disease a whopping 50 percent.

E. Fill in with the correct preposition.

1. Rama went _____ forest.
2. 'Geetanjali' is written _____ Ravindranath Tagore.
3. I prefer Kannada _____ English.
4. Sachin is senior _____ Dhoni.
5. I am fond _____ Dharwad Pedha.
6. Lear divided the property _____ his three daughters.
7. Students go to college _____ bus.
8. What is the time _____ your watch?
9. The soldiers shot the terrorists _____ the gun.
10. The minister was afraid _____ losing his power.
11. They insisted _____ studying MBBS.
12. The PM congratulated Neeraj _____ his success.
13. The manager paid money _____ cheque
14. The price of fuel has increased _____ 12%.
15. There are stars _____ the sky.
16. Lata Mangeshkar was good _____ singing.
17. She held an umbrella _____ her head.
18. We should listen _____ good music.
19. The frog jumped _____ water.
20. There is a clock _____ the wall

21. He is charged _____ cheating and rape.
22. She has been suffering _____ typhoid.
23. We have been learning English _____ LKG.
24. Subhas Chandra Bose left _____ Germany.
25. Power supply to their house has been cut _____.
26. The Mahabharata is translated _____ many languages.
27. The 'Vande Bharat' runs _____ Bengaluru and Hubli.
28. We should always be grateful _____ our nation.
29. Since I was tired I went _____ bed early.
30. She has been in hospital _____ three days.
31. The devotees went to the temple _____ foot.
32. The sun rises _____ the east.
33. He fell _____ his horse and broke his leg.
34. Romeo and Juliet fell in love _____ each other.
35. The doctor advised to give _____ smoking.

7. CONJUNCTION:

A CONJUNCTION is a linking or joining word. It links words, phrases and clauses in a sentence.

Example: 1. He works hard to earn his bread *and* butter.

2. To fight *or* give up that is what we have to decide.
3. *Though* I love him, I cannot excuse his offence.
4. The sky looks clear, *but* it might rain.
5. Vinayak as well as Kamala is leaving for London.

Exercise:

Fill in the blanks with suitable Conjunction:

1. I visit the Grand Canyon _____ I go to Arizona. (once, whenever, wherever)
2. This is the place _____ we stayed last time we visited. (when, how)

3. _____ you win first place, you will receive a prize. (wherever, if, unless)
4. You won't pass the test _____ you study. (when, if, unless)
5. I could not get a seat, _____ I came early. (as, though, when)

INTERJECTION:

An INTERJECTION is a word exclamation, expressing a sudden feeling or excitement. It may be sorrow, pity, blessing, curse, etc.

Example: 1. Oh! I have lost my purse.

2. Alas! The poor woman died in the hospital.
3. Hurrah! We have won the match.
4. Hello! Where are you going?

Exercise:

Choose the correct option to fill in the blanks.

1. _____! I found a hundred rupee note.
 - a. Hey
 - b. Oops
2. _____! That boy is really smart.
 - a. Yes
 - b. Bravo
3. _____! You are really going to London for your higher studies.
 - a. Hey
 - b. What
4. _____! She is leaving for Banaras tomorrow; I can't be without her.
 - a. Alas
 - b. What
5. _____! Kindly have a seat.
 - a. Welcome
 - b. Oh

2. Articles

An *article* is a kind of adjective which is always used with and some information about a noun. There are only two *articles* 'a' or 'an', but they are used very often and are important for using English accurately. An *article* is used to modify a noun, which is a person, place, object, or idea. Technically, an *article* is an adjective - any word that modifies a noun. Usually adjectives modify nouns through description, but *articles* are used instead to point out or refer to nouns.

Examine the following sentences.

- Give me *the* red book.
- Give me *a* red book.
- Give me *an* apple.

A or *an* and *the* are called *articles*.

In (a) there is only one red book; it is a particular red book, but in (b) and (c), there are several red books and apples, and I ask for any one of them, for no particular red book and apple.

The is called the Definite Article and *a* or *an* the Indefinite article.

The is called the Definite Article because it refers to a particular person, place or thing.

A or *an* is called the Indefinite Article because it leaves indefinite the person, place or thing referred to.

A or AN

We use *a* before:

a) A word beginning with a consonant sound:

a) a boy, a girl, a man, a woman, a cat, a dog, a horse, a pen, a pencil.

b) a word beginning with a vowel which has a Y (consonant) sound:

a *Union*, a *University*, a *Useful thing*, a *Uniform*, a *Utensil*, a *European*, a *Eulogy*, a *Ewe*.

c) a word beginning with a vowel which has a W (consonant) a *one-rupee note*, a *one-eyed beggar*, a *one-sided argument*, a *one-man band*, a *one-way road*.

We use *an* before:

a) a word beginning with a vowel which does not have a Y or a W sound:

an *orange*, an *umbrella*, an *urgent telegram*, an *upper class*, an *upper berth*, an *Indian*, an *ass*, an *idiot*.

b) a silent *h*: an *hour*, an *honour*, but a *hint*.

c) An 'h' followed by an unstressed syllable: an historical event, an historical novel, but a *history* lesson.

d) a consonant in an abbreviation which begins with a vowel sound: an M.A., an M.Sc., an M.P., but a B.A., a B.Sc.

The use or non-use of the Indefinite Article

a) The indefinite article *a* or *an* is used before singular countable nouns. To know whether or not a noun is countable, ask yourself if it is the name of something you can count. For example, *boy* is a countable noun because you can say two boys, three boys, etc. On the other hand, *gold* is not a countable noun because you cannot say two golds, three golds, etc. Therefore, we may use *a* before the singular noun *boy*, but not before *gold*. Some of the countable nouns are: a student, a teacher, a postman an American, a garden, an eye, an elephant.

b) Sometimes the indefinite article helps to change an uncountable noun into a countable one. In such cases, the noun usually changes its meaning.

Thus, *a glass* is a vessel from which we drink whereas *glass* is, a hard, brittle, transparent, substance; a *beauty* is a beautiful thing or person

- My brother has *a few* friends (some).
- My brother has *few* friends, (not many).
- I have *a little* time (some). I have little time, (not much).
- in certain phrases before singular nouns:
- I have seen *many* an accident.
- He dislikes *such* a statement.

Use of the Definite Article

The Definite Article 'the' is used:

1. to point out a thing *known* or already *referred to*:
One night a wolf fell in with a dog. *The* wolf was all skin and bone while *the* dog was as fat as he could be.
2. before nouns of which there is only one:
the sun, *the* moon, *the* sea, *the* ocean, *the* earth, *the* sky, *the* world
3. before a noun which, by reason of locality, can represent only one particular thing:
Mary is in *the* garden (i.e., the garden of this house).
He was ill and sent for *the* doctor (i.e., his own doctor).
4. before a common noun made definite by the addition of a phrase or clauses:
the boy who won the race;
the man on the donkey;
the book that I bought.
5. before a singular noun which stands for a whole class: *The* lion is ferocious (lions as a class).
The cow is sacred to the Hindus (cows as a class).
6. before superlative use as nouns:
This is *the* most any man can do It is *the* worst for a long time.

- before a superlative adjective if the adjective qualifies a noun directly or it is followed by of.
Everest is *the highest* mountain in the world.
Sita is *the shortest* girl in the class.
We are *the best* friends.
- before adjectives used as nouns to express an abstract idea or a quality:
The good lives on after a man has died.
A poet is constantly searching for *the beautiful* in life.
- before adjectives used as nouns to denote a whole class:
The rich should help *the poor*.
This adventure is for *the young*.
- before ordinal numbers in titles:
Pope John *the twenty first*;
King George *the sixth*.
- before common nouns followed by a proper noun.
The river Godavari is in space.
The novel 'War and Peace' is a master - piece.
- before a proper noun when it is used as a common noun:
Kalidasa is *the Shakespeare* of India (the greatest dramatist).
Bombay is *the Manchester* of India (the biggest cloth - producing centre).
- before a proper noun only when it is qualified by an adjective:
the great Shivaji;
the immortal Shakespeare;
the wise Solomon; *the famous* Napoleon.
- before the names of certain well - known books:
the Vedas, *the Bible*, *the Koran*, *the Ramayana*.
- before the names of musical instruments in such contexts as the following:

He plays *the violin*, but I play *the trumpet*.
Do you play *the piano*?

16. before trades and professions following a proper noun :
Byron, *the Poet*, Newton, *the Scientist*, Dr. Hero, *the eminent Surgeon*
17. before plural proper names: *the Johnsons*; *the Smiths*; *the Tagores*
18. before the names of ships, trains, aeroplanes, rockets, etc., *the Golden Arrow*; *the Vajrayanti*; *the Gnat*; *the Krishna*.
19. before the names of shops, hotels, inns, restaurants, theatres, clubs, *the Savoy*; *the King's Restaurant*; *the Princess Theatre*; *The Lion Club*; *the Astro Hotel*.
20. before the names of gulfs, rivers, seas, oceans, chains of mountains, groups of islands, plural names of countries or where the type of government is mentioned, and some provinces : *the Persian Gulf*; *the Ganges*, *the Thames*, *the Black sea*, *the Red sea*, *the Indian Ocean*, *the Pacific*, *the Himalayas*, *the Alps*, *the Andamans*, *the West Indies*, *the Netherlands*, *the United Kingdom*, *the Indian Republic*, *the United Provinces*, *the Punjab*, *the Deccan*, *the Carnatic*.
21. before districts when the noun which originally accompanied the proper noun has been dropped : *the Sahara* (desert), *the Gobi* (desert), *the Crimea* (peninsula) etc.
22. before countries and districts from which the adjective has been dropped : *the* (Belgian) Congo; *the* (Anglo-Egyptian) Sudan, *the* (Austrian) Tyrol.
23. When the initials are used: *the U.S.A.*, *the U.S.S.R.*, *the U.N.*, *the W.H.O.*; *the I.A.S.*, *the U.P.S.C.*, *the S.R.*
24. before a noun to give the force of a superlative: This is *the* book on the subject, (i.e., the best book). This is *the* man for the job (i.e., the best man).
25. adverbially in such sentences as : *the fewer*, *the better*; *the more*, *the merrier*.

Omission of the Article

The article is not used:

1. before proper nouns: India is a great country.
Tagore wrote verses in Bengali.
2. before titles followed by a proper noun:
President Kennedy was assassinated.
Doctor Hanemann invented Homoeopathy.
Elizabeth II became *Queen* of England after the death of her father.
3. before common nouns in the plural number used in a general sense:
Boys are generally naughty (general).
Dogs are faithful animals (general).
4. before common nouns in the singular number used in their widest sense:
Man is mortal.
Woman is man's companion in life.
Science tries to discover the laws of *nature*.
5. before material nouns used in a general sense: *Gold* is a valuable metal (material - general). *Cotton* is cultivated on a large scale in India (do). but *the gold* in my ring is too soft (material - particular).
6. before abstract nouns used in a general sense: *Wisdom* is the gift of heaven (Abstract-general). *Honesty* is the best policy (do). but *The Wisdom* of Solomon is well known (Abstract - particular). *The honesty* of that boy is gratifying (do).
7. before the names of sciences, etc., when they are used in a general sense :
Mathematics is a very interesting subject.
Logic is not taught in all schools. Do you learn *history* at school?
8. before superlative adjectives and adverbs used predicatively:
He knows *best* (adverb - superlative of 'well').
That is best (adjective - superlative of 'good').

starting from a point of time in the past or future: I propose to meet him *next* Sunday. I met him at a concert *last* week. But: *The next day* he was still feeling . . .

18. before concrete nouns like *Heaven, Hell, Paradise, Parliament, Congress*: The road to Hell is paved with good intentions. Fate had decided otherwise.
19. before *father, mother, aunt*, etc.: Father is angry, Uncle is cross with us, Mother is kind.
20. before *home* when it means the home of the speaker or the person spoken to: Go home, Stay at home.

Exercises:

Correct the following sentences:

1. Andamans are a group of islands.
THC
2. He restored sight to blind.
3. Dead man tells no lies.
THC
4. Bay of Bengal separates India from the Burma.
THC
5. Poet Tennyson wrote 'In memoriam'.
THC
6. Will you come for walk with me?
7. He is bravest man I know.
8. Himalayas form great barrier on north of India.
9. Sun rises very early in summer.

10. Eagle is bird of prey.
11. The Mount Blanc is highest peak in Alps.
12. We cannot get it for the love or for the money.
13. Ganges is very sacred river.
14. Ceylon is largest of all islands near India.
15. Bird in hand is worth two in bush.
16. The honesty is best policy.
17. I had the dinner at club last night.
18. The man is mortal.
19. He is a Indian and she is an European.
20. Rich should help poor and helpless.
21. She is an university student.
22. Here is an one rupee-note to pay for book.
23. Thought of holidays makes me happy.

24. U.S.S.R. is Communist developed state.
25. Happier you are, better I'm pleased.

Fill in the blanks with the correct Article.

1. He is a very good cricket player.
2. Tomorrow will be a holiday.
3. The art of speaking is very important.
4. The world is not worth living in, because men are so bad.
5. The rich are happy in a world and do not care for poor.
6. Man is a social animal.
7. When do 'you go back to the Punjab.
8. Copper is a useful metal.
9. He is not a honourable man.
10. The lion is a king of beasts.

- C. Fill in the blanks with appropriate articles where ever necessary.

My life is adventure most of time. Nothing happens as planned.
 If I start preparing tea, either milk gets over boiled or tea powder
 I add is insufficient. When Suresh, my brother comes home in
 evenings, he gets irritated when I give him tea. " eight-
 year-old kid can make better tea!", he grumbles." I follow instructions
 on label to last bit", I mumble.

- D. Fill in the blanks with the correct article:

1. He's reading _____ book about new discoveries.
2. She's _____ amazing Rangoli artist.
3. Can you pass me _____ water?
4. I love watching _____ rainbow in the sky.
5. He's _____ the tallest person in the class.

3. Cloze Test

A Cloze Test or Cloze Reading Test is an exercise that tests a student's ability to read a passage with comprehension. It also tests his/her knowledge of vocabulary. The following are a few samples of cloze test.

Fill in the blanks with the appropriate words given in the brackets.

I

Global warming is the long-term warming of the planet's ____ (1) ____

Though this warming has been going on for a long time, its pace has ____ (2) ____ increased in the last hundred years due to the burning of fossil

fuels ____ (3) ____ coal, oil, and natural gas, and burning them causes the

"greenhouse effect" in Earth's atmosphere. The greenhouse ____ (4) ____ is

the process through which heat is trapped near Earth's surface by substances known as 'greenhouse gases.' ____ (5) ____ greenhouse gases are carbon

dioxide, chlorofluorocarbons, water vapor, methane, and nitrous oxide.

These gases prevent the heat ____ (6) ____ leaving the atmosphere. The excess

heat in the atmosphere has caused the global warming. Global warming has presented another issue ____ (7) ____ climate change. Climate change refers

to changes in weather patterns and growing seasons ____ (8) ____ the world.

It also refers to sea level rise caused by the expansion of warmer seas and melting ice sheets and ____ (9) ____ . Global warming causes climate change,

which poses a serious threat to life ____ (10) ____ Earth in the forms of widespread flooding and extreme weather.

(from, around, significantly, effect, glaciers, on, called, these, temperature, like)

II

The constitution is the supreme law of India. It was ____ (1) ____ by

the Constituent Assembly on 26th November 1949 and came into force on 26th January 1950. At the time of its adoption, the Constitution ____ (2) ____

Articles and 8 Schedules and was about 145,000 words long. It is ____ (3) ____ largest written constitution of the world. The ____ (4) ____ of the

Constituent Assembly sat to frame the Constitution, over a period of 2

years and 11 months. The Preamble of the Constitution ____ (5) ____ India a

sovereign, socialist, secular, and democratic Republic and assures its citizens justice, equality, and liberty, and endeavors to ____ (6) ____ fraternity. The

constitutional head of the Executive of the Union is the President. Article ____ (7) ____ of the Constitution provides that there shall be a Council of Ministers

the Prime Minister as its head to aid and advise the President.

Dr. Bhim Rao Ambedkar is ____ (8) ____ as the chief Architect of Indian Constitution. The original Constitution of India is ____ (9) ____ printed nor

typed. It is handwritten and calligraphed in both Hindi and English. It was

handwritten by Sh. Prem Behari Narain Raizada and was published in

Dehradun ____ (10) ____ him. Every page got decorated by Shantiniketan artists including Beohar Rammanohar Sinha and Nandala Bose.

regarded, members, by, declares, promote, adopted, the, contained, neither, members)

GRAMMAR

4
UNIT

1. Tenses

Tense and Aspect represent form of a verb. Look at the different forms the verb give in English.

Forms

Word form

Present tense	Give/Gives
Past tense	Gave
Present Participle	Giving
Past Participle	Given

Notice that there is no future tense form in English. The future time is expressed in different ways.

Aspect is the result of the combination of auxiliary verbs *be* and *have* with participle forms.

Perfective aspect

: *have + past participle*

Progressive aspect

: *be + present participle*

In addition to these, there is simple aspect. Simple aspect is just the Present tense form.

A combination of tense and aspect gives us the following variations:

Tense and Aspect Example

Present Simple / Simple Present	She eats an apple every day.
Present Perfect	She has given an apple to her brother.
Present Progressive	She is eating an apple.
Present Perfect Progressive	She has been eating an apple for 10 minutes.
Past Simple/Simple past	She ate an apple yesterday.
Past Perfect	She had eaten an apple before he went to college.
Past Progressive	She was eating an apple when I went to his house.
Past Perfect Progressive	She had been eating an apple since morning.

Simple Present Tense

a)

The Simple Present tense is used to express what someone does regularly or very often. You often find the adverbs like *every day*, *regularly*, *always*, *every week*, *every month* and *every year* in a sentence indicating this tense. But, even if it is not indicated in a sentence, sometimes the fact that something happens very often is implied.

PRESENT TENSE

b)

1. Jaideep goes to school to drop his children.
 2. Padmini watches television serials regularly.
 3. I go to temple every Saturday.
 4. Majed visits Goa every year.
 5. He works at a local bank situated in the Benz Circle.
 6. She often goes to the orphanage to teach the kids.
 7. He goes to Church every Sunday.
 8. Do you play hockey?
 9. Summer starts in the month of March.
 10. People celebrate Diwali with pomp and glory.
- The Simple Present tense also expresses somebody's / something's present state of being.
1. Deepa is a Public Relation Officer in a Software Company.
 2. I am an army officer.
 3. He is a social worker and helps the disabled.
 4. She is a good musician.
 5. They are close friends.
 6. Dogs are ferocious animals, but they are faithful.
 7. Trees are inevitable for a pollution-free atmosphere.
 8. The sky is cloudy today.
 9. It is difficult to say which political party is ideal nowadays.
 10. This is the car that is liked by many people.

c) Universal Truths and Proverbs are expressed in the Simple Present Tense.

1. Man is a social animal.
2. The sun rises in the east.
3. The moon derives its light from the sun.
4. Dogs are faithful Animals.
5. A bird in the hand is worth two in the bush.
6. To err is human,
7. Man proposes and God disposes.
8. The earth revolves round the sun.

Present Continuous / Present Progressive

a) The Present Continuous is used to talk about things happening now, at this moment. The Present Continuous Verbs are formed with the Present Participle form (ending with *ing*) along with suitable forms of *be* in the present tense form, (*am, is, are*),

1. She is driving a car.
2. The teacher is dictating notes to the students.
3. The salesman is demonstrating a new product.
4. I am writing a list of articles to be bought.
5. He is typing a letter
6. They are listening to the cricket commentary.
7. The players are practising in the field.
8. We are talking about a new film.

b) The Present Continuous is also used to describe things happening around now, but not necessarily at this moment.

1. We are planning to buy a new flat.
2. I am writing a novel.
3. She is working in the Telephone Department.
4. He is looking for a good job.

5. They are waiting for the result.
6. Smitha is working on a project.
7. I am writing a paper on Feminism.
8. The students are preparing for the final exams.

The following verbs which describe a feeling or state, but not action are called stative verbs and they are not used in the continuous form.

agree, appear, believe, belong, concern, consist, contain, depend, deserve, disagree, dislike, doubt, feel, fit, hate, have, hear, imagine, impress, include, involve, know, like, look, love, matter, mean, measure, mind, need, owe, own, prefer, promise, realise, recognise, remember, see, seem, smell, sound, suppose, taste, think, understand, want, weigh, wish, want, smile, notice, recognise, love, hate, desire, prefer, hope, notice, perceive, wonder etc.

1. I am hearing what you say. (Wrong)
2. I hear what you say. (Right)

Present Perfect

The actions that are completed in the immediate past and its relevance is felt in the present are described in the Present Perfect.

look at the following sentences

- Have you finished doing your homework?
 Yes, I have finished my homework.
 No, I haven't finished my homework.
 Has he read this book?

- Yes, he has read this book.
 No, he hasn't read this book.
 Has the train left the station?
 Yes, the train has left the station.
 No, the train hasn't left the station.
 Have they come to class?

Yes, they have come to class.

No, they haven't come to class.

My parents have lived in this house for ten years.

I have been in this city since 1994.

Pawan's uncle has had the same job for more than 18 years.

Anjala has been in this school since 1999.

Have and Has can be pronounced as 'v' and 'z' in the above sentences in their contracted forms.

For example,

I've gone to my office.

She's finished her post-graduation.

Present Perfect Continuous

The actions that started some time ago in the past and which are continuing at the moment of *talking*, are described in the Present Perfect Continuous.

1. They have been constructing a new house for the past three months. (They started the work in the past and the construction is still going on)
2. The management has been renovating the hotel since January.
3. I have been waiting for the bus for 45 minutes.
4. Lalita has been preparing for the examination since February.
5. Vishnu has been watching the cricket match since morning.
6. We have been playing football for one hour.

PAST TENSE

Simple Past

The Simple Past Tense is used to express actions completed in the past. You often find an adverb indicating time in the sentence in the past tense. For example, words or phrases like *yesterday*, *day before yesterday*, *last year*, *last month*, *last week*, *in 1990* etc. indicate past time.

1. I visited Singapore last year.

2. We painted the house last week.

3. Ravinder went to Delhi to take an examination.

4. The Committee passed two resolutions.

5. The train came late.

6. He studied in this college in 1994.

7. Shalini did her M.B.A from Osmania University.

8. Alekhya gave a dance recital at Ravindra Bharathi.

9. Samson deposited money in the State Bank of Mysore, Nellore branch.

10. He escaped the accident in a split second.

You may not find the indication of time in all sentences in the Simple Past tense. Sometimes the time is implied.

I finished my graduation-

He bought two pairs of shoes.

Habits of the past time are also indicated by the simple past tense.

She always carried an umbrella.

Ambarish taught music in the school regularly.

Past Continuous

Actions that were going on at a point of time in the past are expressed in the past continuous. This is represented by 'was/were' followed by the 'ing' form of a verb.

1. I was learning music at Kalaniketan in those days.
2. People were gathering to watch news every day when TV was not as popular as it is now.
3. He was playing for the Air India team.
4. We were going to different places, together when we were young.
5. Dharani was teaching English at St. Ann's School.

Past Perfect

When we express two actions completed in the action completed before the other one is shown in the other is the Past Perfect.

1. The vehicle stopped, when the policeman had signalled.
2. I switched off the lights, after he had slept.
3. Nandita left for her hometown, after she had finished examinations.
4. Ten tents were removed, after everybody had left.
5. I had already reached the railway station, before it was five.

You can also say/write :

I had already reached home.

(' By the time she came to receive me at station is implied)

He had already joined in a good job.

(When he got admission into an MBA is implied)

Past Perfect Continuous

The Past Perfect Continuous is used to describe actions that continued from one point of time to another point of time in the past. (Not continuing now)

For example,

1. I had already been teaching in that college when the appointment letter came from the school.
2. Siva had been working as a part-timer when he got married.
3. He had been driving for six hours when he hit the scooterist.
4. I had been going to a Computer Institute in those days.
5. Radhika had been studying in UK when I was doing my Ph.D.

FUTURE TIME

As mentioned earlier, English does not have inflected forms for the Future Tense. Instead, English future forms are created with the help of the modal auxiliaries, *will* and *shall*.

For example,

1. She will become the next chairperson of the committee.
2. Anjana will drive a new car.
3. I shall present a paper in the seminar.
4. The team will visit the flood affected area next week.

(Will is often mistaken to be a future tense verb, but it is a modal auxiliary verb used in English to indicate actions yet to happen).

Sometimes present simple tense and present continuous forms are also used to indicate future:

1. The train arrives at 6 p.m. tomorrow.
2. I come there this evening.
3. He is visiting our office tomorrow.
4. They are coming to Hyderabad next week.
5. She is returning the day after tomorrow.

Exercises:

- A. Fill in the blanks in the following sentences with suitable verb forms.
 1. Dolphins (live, lives, lived) in water.
 2. The Prime Minister (speak, spoke, spoken) to the victims yesterday.
 3. He (see, saw, had seen) an accident while he was waiting in the bus stop.
 4. The President (will address, was addressing, addresses, addressed) the public tomorrow.
 5. Rohith (distributed, distributing, distributes) sweets on his birthday.
 6. My aunt (ate, eat, eating, eats) an apple every day.

7. I (has been, have been, am) living in a Pen house for the last six months.
 8. Anand (have written, has written) a book on health care.
 9. Varma (preparing, will have been preparing, will prepare) for his examinations by this time next month.
 10. Anita (is going, has been going, was going) to school now.
8. Read the following paragraph and fill in the blanks with suitable verbs.

The earliest people of India about whom we know (live) 4000 to 5000 years ago in the fertile valley of the River Indus. They (learn) to live civilised life for about 1000 years, and then, possibly a great flood (sweep) over them and (drown) them. For centuries no one (know) they had ever existed. In about 1920, when archaeological engineers were digging in the Indus valley, they found the traces of (bury) cities. So archaeologists set to work and they cleared away the sand and silt and uncovered again all that (remain) of the ancient cities.

One of the cities of the Indus Valley was (build) of bricks. Inside there were wide and straight streets and brick houses built in a rectangle with a small garden in the middle. The people had underground drainage system, supply of running water and the bigger houses and staircases. There were many public baths for those who (do) not have private ones. There were temples, a shopping place and granaries to store their grains. The people were (skill) potters and also wove cloth. They (make) beautiful gold, silver and copper ornaments. There were other cities in the Indus Valley. All were (bury) in the sand.

C Fill in each blank with the present continuous tense of the verb in the brackets.

1. The men (repair) the telephone cables so do not disturb them.
2. The cost of buying a house in Dehradun (increase).
3. The bird lovers (observe) the birds through binoculars.
4. The policemen (search) for the kidnappers.
5. One of the trees (lean) dangerously and may fall at any moment.
6. The little girl (sob) in the corner because she is not allowed to go out.
7. The animals (leave) the area because of the drought.
8. Not many tourists (return) to this place because it has lost its charm.
9. The soldiers (drive) the tanks up the hill.
10. (expect) a phone call from Rita this evening.

D. Fill in each blank with the present continuous tense of the verb in the brackets.

A bevy of beautiful models (parade) on the stage. They (wear) beautiful dresses. Every one of them (smile) at the audience and the judges. The judges (sit) in the front row. They (write) something on their pads. The judges (select) a model to be crowned 'Miss Earth'. They (award) points to

each contestant. The compere (announce) the name of each contestant. The audience of ten thousand like the contest. They (clap) their hands and (enjoy) themselves.

E. Rewrite the sentences using the present perfect tense form of the verbs in colour by using already, just and not yet. Use the clues in the brackets wherever given.

1. Rashmi registers for the dance class. (She is handing in the form now)

2. Ms Savita collects used clothes to give to the poor. She has not sorted them out.

3. A wasp stings Ravi. He has not applied ointment on the wound.

4. Raman is proud of the kites he makes. (He is flying it for the first time)

5. The building is burning. Sandeep calls the fire engine but it has not arrived

6. It is raining! The mason has not repaired my roof so I put buckets all over my house to catch the rainwater.

7. The kitchen is now tidy and clean because Preeti stacks up the dishes neatly.

8. Mr Singh donates blood at the hospital. He has to rest for a while before he can leave.

F. Fill in each blank with the present perfect or present perfect continuous tense of the verb given in the brackets.

1. John on the laptop since 6 o'clock. (play)

2. John and his family India for three weeks. (travel)

3. John and his family four different states so far. (visit)

4. Why are your hair all wet? Oh, I (swim).

5. I the guitar for two hours and I'm very tired. (practise)

6. Dev Anand is an evergreen actor. He in a number of famous films. (act)

7. Mum all morning and she is covered in sweat. (cook)

8. The cooking is finished. Mum eight different dishes. (make)

6. Fill in the blanks with the correct present perfect or present perfect continuous form of the verb in brackets.

Professor Brainer (work) on a time machine for many years now. He (try) to prove that time travel is possible

- but so far (not be) successful. For some time now, he
and his wife (experiment) with different types
of energy for the machine, such as gas, petrol and electricity. But so far
nothing (work). Recently the professor
..... (consider) the possibility of using solar power and he
..... (set) up a laboratory in the middle of the Thar Desert!
..... (not solve) the problem.
But sadly, he and his wife still (dream) about time travel and some people,
Many people (write) books about it. But it is just a
like H.G. Wells, (go) back and forth to the moon for
dream! Yes, we (manage) to explore Mars and
over 40 years, and we (think) about time travel is just a dream. What do you think?
outer space. But I think time travel is just a dream. What do you think?
H. Choose the correct simple past or past continuous form of the verbs
given in the Brackets and fill in the blanks.
1. I a lovely time near the lake at the weekend. (have)
 2. I all the answers in the test. (know)
 3. This time last week we to Singapore. (fly)
 4. I tennis when it to rain.
(play, start)
 5. Jane in the park when she
a ring. (walk, find)
 6. The explorer Columbus to get to India when
he in America. (try, land)
 7. That man and on his mobile
phone at the same time. (drive, speak)

8. I remember my great grandfather very well. He
..... always (use, smile)
 9. Yesterday I ill so I complete
rest. (feel, take)
 10. Yesterday I a really good film. (watch)
- Fill in the blanks with the past continuous tense of the verbs in the
brackets.
- Priya : Hello, Shreya I called last night but you were out.
Shreya : Oh, I (enjoy) myself at the fair last
night. Didn't you go?
Priya : No, I (revise) my lessons. What did
you see at the fair?
Shreya : A few young girls (sing) Hindi songs
on a stage. They (sing) out of tune, I
think.
Priya : What else did you see?
Shreya : A magician (perform) on a corner
stage. He (wear) long black coat.
J. Fill in the blanks with simple past or past continuous form of the
verbs given in the brackets.
- Haroun-al-Rashid was the Caliph of Baghdad. He was a good ruler and
cared for his people. One day he (decide) to look around
the city. As he (walk) through the city, he
(pass) an old, blind beggar. The beggar (ask) passers-by
for money. The kind Caliph (gave) the man a coin. The

beggar asked to hit him. Haroun was so surprised that he
 (order) the beggar to come to the court and explain. Next day the beggar
 came and (tell) him the story. His name was Baba Abdullah
 and he had been a rich merchant. One day he (come)
 back from a town while he (meet) a holy man. They
 (make) friends and (have) a meal
 together. As they (eat), the holy man (tell) the
 merchant about some treasure that was hidden nearby. The holy man said
 they could share the treasure if Baba Abdullah would help him carry it.

K. Fill in the blanks with the past perfect form of the verbs given in
 the brackets.

1. Ravi didn't have a pen because he it.
 (lose)
2. When we arrived at the cinema, the picture
 (start)
3. We our dinner before aunt arrived.
 (finish)
4. Aunt Vinni was tired because she hard. (work)
5. Rita's knee was bleeding. She off her bike.
 (fall)
6. As we were leaving the house, Dad turned back, he his
 mobile phone. (forget)
7. They passed the test because they hard.
 (work)

the verbs provided in the simple past or the past perfect,
 using the passive forms, as you think suitable.

- The clock (strike) midnight, and I still
 (not, fall) asleep.
 (You, Already, Learn) some Hindi when you
 first (come) to live here?
 The man (escape) by the time the police
 (arrive) to arrest him.
 My test results (be) much better than I
 (expect) them to be.
 She suddenly (recollect) where she
 (hide) the money.
 I (not, realize) the phone
 (disconnected).
 I (barely, shut) the front door when I
 (remember) the key (be)
 still inside.
 When I (return) from holiday, my new
 neighbours (moved) in.
 I hastily (close) the gate, but two cows
 (already, walk) out on the road.
 The police (clear) the street before the
 procession (approach).

M.

Use the verbs provided in the future perfect. You may have to use the passive. *(hear)* about the change of

1. You *(not, mark)* yet plan already.

2. The exam papers *(come)* as a terrible shock

3. The news to her parents.

4. Not all the relatives of the victims *(inform)* yet

5. Our guests *(eat)* on the journey, I expect. *(not, be)* the first time he has

6. It come across bullying in the school.

7. I *(not, complete)* my assignment in time to hand it in tomorrow.

8. I guess you *(seen)* the report of the cyclone in the paper.

9. The police *(not, have)* time to contact the relatives.

10. The exams *(begin)*, by this time next week.

N. Correct the following sentences and rewrite them.

1. She worked so hard that she falls ill.

2. I hoped you will pass.

3. She cried as if she is crazy.

4. The teacher told us that everything was attracted towards the centre of the earth.

5. He always said that honesty was the best policy.

6. I met a person when he is in his room.

7. He has finished his work before his father arrived.

8. He thought that he is in the heavens.

9. He works hard so that he might succeed in the test.

10. Newton discovered that the force of gravitation made apples fall.

11. She said that she is not in a position to help anyone.

12. He said that you are an intelligent boy.

1. SKIMMING

Skimming and scanning are two very different strategies for speed reading. They are each used for different purposes, and they are not meant to be used all the time. They are at the fast end of the speed-reading range, while studying is at the slow end. People who know how to skim and scan are flexible readers. They read according to their purpose and get the information they need quickly without wasting time. They do not read everything and that is the secret of their speed reading. Their skill lies in knowing what specific information to read and which method to use.

What Is Skimming?

Skimming is one of the tools we can use to read more in less time. Skimming refers to looking only for the general or main ideas, and works best with non-fiction (or factual) material. Skimming does not give a whole picture in detail because we don't read everything. We read only what is important to our purpose.

How to skim: Skimming is not a haphazard process, placing the eyes where ever they fall. To skim effectively, there has to be a structure. In skimming, we don't read everything. What we read is more important than what we leave out. So, what material do we choose to read and what material do we leave out?

When we start reading a big text or chapter, by reading the first few paragraphs in detail, we will get a good idea of what information will be discussed. Once we know where the reading is headed, we can begin to read only the first sentence of each paragraph. Also called topic sentences, they give us the main idea of the paragraph.

At the end of each topic sentence, our eyes should drop down through the rest of the paragraph, looking for important pieces of information, such as names, dates, or events. The letters in bold, sub-headings, titles of chapters, graphics provided are helpful in skimming. Continue to read only topic sentences, dropping down through the rest of the paragraphs, until we are near the end. Since the last few paragraphs may contain a conclusion

2. Reading Skills

In the earlier units we have seen how new vocabulary is added to us and learnt that acquaintance and confidence in using the right words and learnt that acquaintance and confidence in using the right words and learnt that acquaintance and confidence in using the right words

right context increases our communication skills. We can do that through reading, not reading occasionally but reading regularly. Reading is fundamental to function in today's society. It is a vital finding a good job and in qualifying in competitive examinations. Reading is important because it develops the mind. Understanding the word is one way the mind grows in its ability. It develops the mind and the creative side of people. Reading is fundamental in developing a good self-image. Non-readers or poor readers often have low self-esteem and their abilities. There is a strong correlation between reading and academic success.

We have many sources to improve our reading skills. Books, magazines and even the Internet are great learning tools which require the reader to read and understand what is read. A person who knows how to read can educate himself, or be a self-learner in any area of life he/she is interested in. We live in an age where we overflow with information, but reading is the main way to take advantage of it.

How can we become good readers? What are the qualities of good readers? Do they use the same style always?

Good readers are focused readers. They develop certain traits like: trying the purpose of their reading and deciding their style accordingly, ability to draw on their background knowledge as they read, make connections on what might happen logically/creatively, use their imagination to visualize (in their mind's eye) what they read, recognize the text's tone, the writer's voice as well as any confusion in it (if any).

So, reading demands different styles depending on the purpose. Sometimes we may use speed reading techniques like skimming and scanning, sometimes critical reading, intensive reading or extensive reading

or summary, we should stop skimming there and read in detail. If while skimming, we feel we are grasping the main ideas, then we are skimming correctly.

When to skim: Because skimming is done at a fast pace with less-than-normal comprehension, we shouldn't skim all the time. There are many times, however, when skimming is very useful. When we have to read large texts or solid information and articles in a short time, skimming will locate the information usable for presentations, research etc. Skimming is useful for revision before examinations, for a quick review, to locate the material we need to focus on. In day-to-day activities, skimming is used for reading the newspapers, magazines etc. Once a topic of interest is identified, we can go into the details.

While skimming, we must ask ourselves some questions to help decide whether or not to skim. If we get a positive or affirmative answer, then skimming is a useful tool. We must see if the material is non-fiction, if the time we have is less and the content is more, if we already know something about it/have some background knowledge about it and if any of the material can be skipped.

If we have sufficient background knowledge or believe we don't need the information, we can skip it!

2. SCANNING

(Scanning is another useful tool for speeding up our reading.) In skimming overall idea or comprehension is gained by speed reading. In scanning, we look only for a specific fact or piece of information without reading everything. It is selective reading where we know what we want from the text. We scan when we look for our favourite T.V show in a schedule, a phone number in a telephone book, and for the sports scores in the newspaper, a date or day in a calendar etc.)

For scanning to be successful, we must understand how the material is structured so that we can locate the specific information needed. Scanning allows us to find details and other information in a hurry. We use scanning very often in our daily activities, without knowing its definition.

How to scan: Establishing our purpose, locating the appropriate material, and knowing how the information is structured before we start scanning is essential.

Generally, the material we scan is typically arranged in the following ways: alphabetically, chronologically, non-alphabetically, by category, or actually. Alphabetical information is arranged in order from A to Z, while chronological information is arranged in time or numerical order. Information can be also be arranged in non-alphabetical order, such as a television listing, or by category, listings of items such as an auto parts catalogue. Sometimes information is located within the written paragraphs of text, also known as a textual sense, as in an encyclopaedia entry. Keep the concept of key words in mind while scanning.

Learning to use our hands while scanning is very helpful in locating specific information, be it a word in a dictionary, a meeting time in a calendar, a train or bus schedule. Using our hand or finger is extremely helpful in focusing our attention and keeping our place while scanning a column of material. Our peripheral vision can also help us scan effectively. When our hand moves down a list of names, we see not only the name our finger is pointing to, but also the names above and below. Let our eyes work for us when searching for information.

When to scan: We scan when our aim is to find specific pieces of information. If we were doing the research for an oral presentation, we could scan the index of books, web sites, and reference materials to see whether they contain any information we want and the pages where the information can be found.

The more we practice, the more effective scanning will become. Finally, the most important benefit of scanning is its ability to help us become more flexible readers.

(<http://www.howtolearn.com/2013/02/skimming-and-scanning-two-important-strategies-for-speeding-up-your-reading/>)

3. INTENSIVE READING AND EXTENSIVE READING

Intensive Reading is sometimes called "Narrow Reading". As the name itself suggests, it is not casual reading. It is used when we want a full conscious patient reading strategy. It is used when we guess the meanings of words from their context. Intensive reading is academic reading where the reader observes and studies the logical argument and rhetorical pattern, the purpose of the author and his attitude towards the topic, the emotional, symbolic and social attitude. It is used to read content or a text that is difficult.

Experts call intensive reading as a "zoom lens" strategy. Intensive reading draws attention to grammatical forms, literal and symbolic meanings. It develops good reading skills and helps to expand the vocabulary. Reading new words puts them in the mind for later use. Seeing how words are used in different contexts can give a better understanding of the word usage and definitions than the meanings of a dictionary. Intensive reading improves comprehension skills.

In intensive reading, texts are read carefully and thoroughly, again and again. The aim is to build more language knowledge rather than simply practice the skill of reading. It is not used to read very lengthy texts.

Extensive Reading is the opposite of intensive reading, just as skimming is the opposite of scanning in speed reading. It is a pleasurable activity or method of reading, not under pressure for any specific, immediate target. It is self-directed, as we choose what we want to read for pleasure, information and general understanding. Reading is its own reward. (Novels by one author or several authors, stories, articles, authentic materials like newspapers, web sources... anything could be used for extensive reading.)

It is useful to develop a reading habit and gain confidence. It helps us become motivated and independent readers who can change their reading strategies depending on their purpose and the kind of text. It does not teach particularly any reading skills as intensive reading does because it is a

reading habit which is not supervised and tested. However, it develops automatically language and grammar competence, vocabulary, background knowledge and confidence.

4. COMPREHENSION

We know that comprehension means understanding something. In listening, effective listening is only when we can understand the intention of the speaker accurately. (taking into consideration) the non-verbal hints too. Similarly, in reading, comprehension is not mere superficial understanding of the written word. Some good reading skills are particularly important for comprehending what is generally known as 'information reading or expository reading'. No wonder, all competitive examinations give so much importance to comprehension skills.

A good reader can comprehend a text in the first reading, summarize it, draw inferences, see a logical sequence in the writing, compare and contrast it with other texts he might have read and draw on his background knowledge. He can question his understanding of the passage, draw conclusions and even solve problems. He can separate facts from opinions in the passage and find the main ideas, supporting details etc.

Good comprehension should be at the literal level, interpretive level and applied level also. As the time given for answering questions for comprehension passages is limited, we should develop fast reading skills as well as critical reading skills in order to compete and succeed. Both intensive and Extensive reading help to enhance general comprehension skills.

Sample passage for comprehension

Answer the questions after reading the passage

Did you know that spiders are not insects? They are actually called arachnids, a group of animals related to insects that have eight legs and that have venom. There are many different kinds of spiders. They live all over the world and can be found in just about every habitat. Most like dark places, which may include your home, closets, or basement!

Spiders are very interesting. Some spin silk webs to catch and eat prey, while others attack their prey. Some spiders, like tarantulas, are large enough to eat lizards and mice! Many people are afraid of spiders because they bite. Most spiders, however, will only bite if they think they are dangerous and most are harmless. Spiders are actually helpful to people because many eat insect pests like cockroaches and mosquitoes.

1. Which question is NOT answered in the passage?

- A. How many legs do spiders have?
- B. How long do spiders live?
- C. What do spiders eat?
- D. Where would I find a spider?

2. Why are spiders helpful to people?

- A. Some eat lizards.
- B. Some eat insect pests.
- C. They have eight legs.
- D. They live all over the world.

3. Spiders are

- A. Related to insects
- B. Tarantulas
- C. All harmful
- D. Insects

4. Spiders have

- A. eight legs
- B. Four legs
- C. The passage does not mention
- D. Six legs

5. Which is not true about spiders?

- A. Spiders are actually helpful to people.
- B. All spiders are dangerous.
- C. Some spiders attack their prey.
- D. Spiders like dark places

Exercise:

Read the passages and answer the questions given.

PASSAGE 1:

In the heart of the forest, nestled among towering trees, lies a hidden treasure waiting to be discovered. Deep within the lush greenery, a small stream gurgles gently, its crystal-clear waters meandering through the moss-covered rocks. Birds chirp merrily overhead, adding to the symphony of nature. As I wandered through the dense foliage, I stumbled upon a quaint little cottage, its thatched roof peeking out from behind a curtain of vines. Curiosity piqued, I approached cautiously, wondering who could inhabit such a secluded abode.

To my surprise, an elderly man emerged from the shadows, his weather-beaten face creased with a warm smile. Introducing himself as the guardian of the forest, he regaled me with tales of its wonders and mysteries. As the sun dipped below the horizon, casting a golden glow over the treetops, I bid farewell to my newfound friend, grateful for the adventure that awaited me in this enchanted forest.

Questions:

1. Where is the hidden treasure located?
2. Describe the surroundings of the hidden treasure.
3. What do you find inside the forest?
4. Who emerges from the cottage?
5. How does the elderly man greet the visitor?

Answers:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

PASSAGE 2:

High above the clouds, where the sky meets the earth, lies a kingdom of dreams known as Cloudland. Here, fluffy white clouds drift lazily across the azure sky, casting shadows on the emerald-green meadows below.

In Cloudland, everything is possible. Rainbows stretch across the horizon, painting the sky in vibrant hues of red, orange, yellow, green, blue, indigo, and violet. Silver linings adorn every cloud, promising hope and happiness to all who gaze upon them. As I soar through the cotton candy skies, I marvel at the beauty and wonder of Cloudland. It is a place where imagination knows no bounds and dreams take flight on wings of fantasy.

Questions:

1. What is Cloudland?
2. Describe the sky in Cloudland.
3. What can be seen stretching across the horizon?
4. What do silver linings on clouds promise?
5. How does the narrator feel as he soars through the skies of Cloudland?

Answers:

1. Kingdom of dreams known as Cloudland.

2.

3. Rainbows

4.

5.

PASSAGE 3:

The Earth is the third planet from the Sun and the only known planet to support life. It has a diameter of approximately 12,742 kilometers and is the fifth largest planet in the solar system. The Earth is a rocky planet with a solid outer crust and a molten inner core. Its atmosphere is composed of nitrogen, oxygen, and trace amounts of other gases.

The Earth's rotation on its axis causes day and night. The Sun causes the seasons. The Earth's axial tilt is responsible for the variation in sunlight received by different parts of the planet throughout the year, resulting in the seasons. The Earth's magnetic field, created by the motion of molten iron in its core, helps to protect the planet from harmful solar radiation. The Earth is also unique in its abundance of water, which covers approximately 71% of its surface. This water is essential for life and plays a crucial role in regulating the planet's temperature and climate.

Questions:

1. What is the Earth?
2. How does the Earth's rotation cause day and night?
3. What causes the seasons on Earth?
4. What is the Earth's magnetic field and why is it important?
5. What is unique about the Earth's abundance of water?

Answers:

1.

2.

3.

4.

5.

PASSAGE 4:

Penicillin is one of the most useful drugs invented by man. With its help, we can heal wounds caused by bacteria which cannot be otherwise healed. In the beginning, very few people knew of this wonderful discovery or its uses. First the scientists and then the ministers of governments were interested in it. Since penicillin could save the wounded soldiers, it was helpful in war. So, they decided to encourage the process of manufacture. Vast factories were set up for preparing it. Lives of hundreds and thousands of soldiers were saved with its help. Most people benefitted from it. Penicillin when introduced into the streams of the human blood, acts as an aid to those parts which are always fighting the deadly germs. It does not have power over every kind of bacteria, but certain kinds are destroyed by penicillin in the great majority of cases.

Questions:

1. What saved the wounded soldiers?
2. Who were interested in the discovery of Penicillin in the beginning?
3. How was penicillin useful in wars?
4. How does penicillin act on human blood?
5. Fill in the blank with a suitable word from the passage.
The water level decreases in the _____ in winters

Answers:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

3. Synonyms and Antonyms

SYNONYMS

A word or phrase that means exactly or nearly the same as another word or phrase in the same language. So, a synonym is a word of similar meaning. Example: The synonyms for student are learner, trainee, pupil, and disciple. When you learn synonyms it is necessary that you should know their correct usage also. For instance, *surprise* and *wonder* have similar meanings and can be used as verbs, but *surprise* is a transitive verb and *wonder* is an intransitive verb. Hence, they should be used in a sentence as illustrated below:

I was surprised at his skill.

I wondered at his skill.

You have, therefore, to take special care about the appropriate usage of words. Otherwise your sentences may be wrong in usage. Study the following lists of words, each consisting of some words which share a common area of meaning. Note that all of them are not synonyms.

You can take the help of a dictionary to identify the synonyms and those that are not.

- ❖ help - aegis - protection - sponsorship - auspices - support - patronisation - assistance - aid - succour - service.
- ❖ discord - disagreement - dispute - quarrel - dissent - dissension - altercation - litigation - imbroglio - argument.
- ❖ amenity - etiquette - civility - politeness - comity - courtesy - friendliness
- ❖ similarity - comparison - analogy - resemblance - correspondence - parallelism - simile - metaphor - parable - similitude - allegory.
- ❖ suffering - agony - torment - struggle - mortification - chagrin, embarrassment - shame - humiliation - insult - disgrace - ordeal - tribulation - distress - affliction - sorrow - crucifixion - catastrophe.
- ❖ anomaly - irregularity - abnormality - lapse - deviation - caprice - defect.
- ❖ apathy - indifference - lack of feeling - lethargy - torpor - stupor.

- ❖ Teacher – tutor, trainer, mentor, instructor, lecturer, professor,
- ❖ antagonist – rival – opponent – adversary.
- ❖ Miserly – stingy, niggardly, tight fisted.
- ❖ brevity – shortness – conciseness.
- ❖ censure – criticism – condemnation – admonition – castigation.
- ❖ clarity – elucidation, transparency, crystalline,
- ❖ coalition – combination – alliance – conjecture – guess – inference –
- ❖ supposition – speculation – assumption – presumption – postulation –
- ❖ proposition – hypothesis.
- ❖ contour – outline – profile.
- ❖ counsel – advice.
- ❖ covenant – solemn agreement – pact – contract.
- ❖ criterion – basis – standard – parameter – norm.
- ❖ defy – oppose – challenge.
- ❖ deluge – downpour – flood – inundation.
- ❖ demeanour – conduct – behaviour – manner – mein – deportment.
- ❖ derelict – hobo – wanderer – tramp
- ❖ despot – tyrant – dictator – autocrat.
- ❖ ruler – chieftain – king – viceroy – sovereign – autocrat – monarch –
- ❖ oligarch – patriarch.
- ❖ dexterity – skill – adroitness – proficiency – facility.
- ❖ dirge – funeral hymn – song of grief – requiem – obituary – necrology
- ❖ – lamentation – elegy.
- ❖ discretion – prudence – wise restraint – judiciousness – circumspection
- ❖ Half – semi, hemi, demi
- ❖ duplicity – double cross – deception.
- ❖ effigy – image – mannequin.
- ❖ Symbol – icon – logo – image.
- ❖ Graveyard – church yard – burial ground – crematorium.
- ❖ epithet – title – appellation – name.
- ❖ epoch – era – age – period – century – millennium – eon.

- ❖ exigency – urgent need – requirement.
- ❖ exuberance – overflow of feelings – zestfulness.
- ❖ ebullience – enthusiasm – elation.
- ❖ facade – front – face.
- ❖ fetish – talisman – amulet.
- ❖ worship – idolatry – heliolatry – zoolatry – bibliolatry.
- ❖ fluctuate – vary – undulate – vacillate – falter – hesitate
- ❖ fugitive – runaway – refugee.
- ❖ guile – deceit – trickery.
- ❖ harbinger – forerunner – precursor – herald.
- ❖ hegemony – leadership – dominance.
- ❖ hyperbole – exaggeration – overstatement.
- ❖ illusion – delusion – mirage – hallucination.
- ❖ incentive – stimulus – impulse – impetus.
- ❖ indignation – anger – pique – annoyance – resentment – imitation –
- ❖ exasperation – rage – wrath – fury.
- ❖ indolence – laziness – sloth – lethargy – sluggishness – drowsiness –
- ❖ supineness – laxness – inertness – passivity – inactivity – somnolence.
- ❖ inference – conclusion – deduction.
- ❖ insolence – insulting behaviour – impudence.
- ❖ insurrection – armed uprising – rebellion – revolt – insurgence – mutiny
- ❖ – revolution.
- ❖ integrity – uprightness – rectitude.
- ❖ interment – burial – cremation.
- ❖ jargon – lingo – cant – argot – slang – gobbledygook – gibberish –
- ❖ balderdash – bombast – verbosity – fustian.
- ❖ libel – defamation – slander – calumny – scandal – malignment.
- ❖ maxim – aphorism – proverb – adage – dictum – truism – canon – epigram
- ❖ – axiom.
- ❖ medley – jumble – alloy – amalgam – motley.
- ❖ nepotism – favouritism.

- ❖ nonchalance - indifference - unconcern.
- ❖ obeisance - respect - courtesy (courtesy) - genuflection - kowtow.
- ❖ omen - portent - foreboding.
- ❖ opulence - wealth - abundance - affluence.
- ❖ paradox - selfcontradiction.
- ❖ parity - equality - equivalence.
- ❖ profit - benefit - bonus - bounty - premium - dividend.
- ❖ pessimistic - splenetic - cynical - saturnine - despondent - disconsolate - melancholic - misanthropic, hopeless - gloomy - dejected - grave - serious.
- ❖ plagiarism - copying / stealing ideas.
- ❖ precision - accuracy - exactness.
- ❖ predilection - bias - preference - predisposition.
- ❖ prerogative - privilege - right.
- ❖ propensity - bent - natural tendency - penchant.
- ❖ rapture - ecstasy - thrill - excitement - delight - gusto - enchantment - transport - trance.
- ❖ reminiscence - recollection - retrospection.
- ❖ repose - rest - quiet.
- ❖ restitution - restoration - reparation - rehabilitation - compensation - indemnification - reinstatement - recuperation.
- ❖ retinue - cortege - convoy.
- ❖ sagacity - shrewdness - sound judgement.
- ❖ penetration - perspicacity - judiciousness - discretion - acumen - acuteness - astuteness.
- ❖ sanction - approval - authorization.
- ❖ stratum - layer - level.
- ❖ subterfuge - trick - excuse - scheme - artifice - ruse - feint.
- ❖ surfeit - excess - surplus.
- ❖ temerity - rashness - recklessness - boldness - audacity - effrontery - impudence - presumption.
- ❖ tenacity - perseverance - persistence.

- ❖ therapy - treatment - healing.
- ❖ veracity - truthfulness - verity - verisimilitude.
- ❖ verge - edge - border - brim.
- ❖ vicissitudes - irregular changes - ups and downs.

Exercise :

Choose the synonym. Tick the right option

- | | | | | |
|---------------|---------------|---------------|-----------------|---------|
| kind | A. nice ✓ | B. wild | C. funny | D. best |
| glad | | | | |
| A. broken | B. happy ✓ | C. open | D. round | |
| Fast | | | | |
| A. clear | B. main | C. clean | D. quickly ✓ | |
| shiny | | | | |
| A. extra | B. careful | C. bright ✓ | D. angry | |
| big | | | | |
| A. large ✓ | B. many | C. next | D. only | |
| Noisy | | | | |
| A. first | B. loud ✓ | C. afraid | D. small | |
| final | | | | |
| A. last ✓ | B. first | C. heavy | D. small | |
| great | | | | |
| A. very soft | B. very loud | C. very hard | D. very good ✓ | |
| Tired | | | | |
| A. kind | B. sleepy ✓ | C. ready | D. angry | |
| tiny | | | | |
| A. very loose | B. very happy | C. very thick | D. very small ✓ | |
| merry | | | | |
| A. safe | B. happy ✓ | C. upset | D. angry | |
| unhappy | | | | |

- A. playful B. alive C. sad D. angry
entire
- A. half B. whole C. most D. pure E. funny
brief
- A. half B. short C. near D. soon E. close
Harsh
- A. pretty B. strange C. cruel D. pleasant E. angry
wicked
- A. wrong B. evil C. ingenious D. helpful E. good
broad
- A. thin B. wide C. deep D. big E. small
terrified
- A. wimpy B. anxious C. nervous D. scared E. horrified
ecstatic
- A. very happy B. very sad C. very loud D. very small E. very proud
vigilant
- A. passionate B. powerful C. remote D. faithful E. aware

ANTONYMS

Antonyms are words that have opposite meanings. This opposition may be with reference to a particular meaning of the given word.

For example :

1. civil x military
2. civil x criminal
3. civil x uncivil (= impolite)

Similarly the 'opposition' may be in terms of a particular aspect of the meaning - complex.

For example :

4. man x woman
5. man x boy
6. man x beast

In (4) the 'gender' is being contrasted; in (5) 'adult-hood' is being contrasted; in (6) 'human' aspect is being contrasted. A 'man' is an adult male human (being). An antonymous term may be a separate word (true x false) or grammatically marked antonym (true x untrue). Here are some antonymous pairs for illustration.

- | | | |
|---------------|---|-----------|
| 7. above | x | below |
| 8. accept | x | reject |
| 9. acquit | x | convict |
| 10. advance | x | retreat |
| 11. affirm | x | deny |
| 12. ancient | x | modern |
| 13. a) agree | x | disagree |
| 14. b) agree | x | differ |
| 15. arrival | x | departure |
| 16. barren | x | fertile |
| 17. beautiful | x | ugly |
| 18. a) common | x | uncommon |
| 19. b) common | x | rare |
| 20. dark | x | light |
| 21. red | x | black |

When a bank account is overdrawn, the account is 'in the red', if it is not overdrawn it is 'in the black'.

20. red x green

This opposition is found in the case of traffic signals.

21. dawn x dusk
22. debit x credit
23. deep x shallow
24. defendant x plaintiff
25. dwarf x giant
26. exit x entrance
27. exterior x interior
28. famous x obscure

antonymy homonymy

RHYTHMIC COMPOSITION

29.	fat	x	lean
30.	float	x	sink
31.	forget	x	remember
32.	gain (n)	x	loss
33.	gain (v)	x	lose
34.	general	x	special
35.	gentle	x	rough
36.	genuine	x	spurious
37.	glut	x	scarcity
38.	guilty	x	innocent
39.	harsh	x	gentle
40.	hate	x	love
41.	help	x	harm
42.	hero	x	villain
43.	honour	x	shame
44.	hope	x	despair
45.	host	x	guest
46.	idle	x	busy
47.	import	x	export
48.	increase	x	decrease
49.	inferior	x	superior
50.	input	x	output
51.	joy	x	sorrow
52.	knowledge	x	ignorance
53.	lend	x	borrow
54.	literal	x	figurative
55.	a) lose	x	find
	b) lose	x	gain
56.	major	x	minor
57.	a) master	x	servant
	b) master	x	pupil

RHYTHMIC COMPOSITION

58.	material	x	spiritual
59.	maternal	x	paternal
60.	matrilineal	x	patrilineal
61.	a) mobile	x	immobile
	b) mobile	x	stationary
62.	narrow	x	broad/wide
63.	negative	x	positive
64.	a) odd	x	even (numbers)
	b) odd	x	usual/normal
65.	offer	x	refuse
66.	often	x	seldom
67.	omission	x	inclusion
68.	optimistic	x	pessimistic
69.	oral	x	written
70.	partly	x	wholly
71.	permanent	x	temporary
72.	pleasure	x	pain
73.	precede	x	succeed
74.	promote	x	demote
75.	public	x	private
76.	quiet	x	noisy
77.	question	x	answer
78.	quote	x	unquote
79.	rapid	x	slow
80.	rise	x	fall
81.	rough	x	smooth
82.	rude	x	polite
83.	sacred	x	profane
84.	safe	x	unsafe
85.	servant	x	master
86.	sharp	x	blunt
87.	simple	x	complex

88. solid x liquid
 89. a) succeed x fail
 b) succeed x precede
 90. tall x short
 91. thick x thin
 92. top x bottom
 93. take x give
 94. upper x lower
 95. vague x definite
 96. victory x defeat
 97. virtue x vice
 98. voluntary x compulsory
 99. wise x foolish
 100. zenith x nadir

Exercises :

A. Find out the antonym for italicized word from the options given below:

- 1 The new boss is well known for his *rigid* approach to all problems.
 a) swift b) logical c) sympathetic d) flexible ✓
 2 *Adversity* is the source of numerous vices.
 a) wealth b) prosperity ✓ c) luxury d) money
 3 His *repulsive* behaviour could not be ignored.
 a) attractive ✓ b) mild c) lovely d) admirable
 4 He is an *amateur* photographer.
 a) average b) skilled c) experienced d) professional ✓
 5 The witness *affirmed* on oath that he was an eyewitness to the crime under study.
 a) disputed ✓ b) denied ✓ c) contradicted d) opposed

- 6 On the hillside, he could see the *vague* shapes of sheep coming through the mist.
 a) clear b) transparent c) plain d) apparent
 7 His *casual* remarks were taken note of by all members of the board.
 a) careful b) precise c) sincere d) flawless
 8 If you *pamper* the child you will regret it.
 a) scold b) discourage c) scorn d) neglect ✓
 9 These rules are not to *prevent* further appointments.
 a) facilitate ✓ b) expedite c) accelerate d) aggravate
 10 The artist led a very *ausere* life.
 a) luxurious b) exciting c) boisterous d) eventful
 11 The last show of the concert at Red Fort was a *fasco*.
 a) triumph b) victory c) fruitful d) success
 12 The members of the opposition party made *derogatory* remarks about the P.M.
 a) praiseworthy b) respectable c) laudatory d) admirable
 13 His writings have been much *eulogized* by Indian scholars.
 a) condemned b) disappeared c) flouted d) disparaged
 14 Their meeting was very *boisterous*.
 a) noisy b) calm c) quiet d) businesslike
 15 She has suspended her secretary on a *flimsy* ground.
 a) sound b) salutary c) strong d) vigorous
 16 They took note of the *humility* of the visiting dignitary.
 a) grandeur b) arrogance c) friendliness d) decency
 17 His friends liked everything about him except his *fugality*.
 a) Punctuality b) extravagance c) shabbiness d) short-temper
 18 He has a *sulky* disposition.
 a) kind b) loving c) cheerful d) mild

19

He is well known for coming up with *impracticable* solutions.

- a) easy b) possible c) feasible d) alternate

20

After the game all the players felt *elated*.

- a) mournful b) melancholy c) distressed d) dejected

B.

Rewrite the following replacing the words in italics with their antonyms :

- i) He was *convicted* by the court.

- ii) He is not *guilty*.

- iii) Don't be so *formal*.

- iv) She was a *miser*.

- v) We *liked* the stranger.

- vi) Did you *wake up* at 10 p.m.?

- vii) They are absolutely *wrong*.

- viii) It was a further *blessing*.

- ix) Luck *favours* the brave.

- x) The *complainant* was absent at the court.

- ① Our Covarina Tree → Toru Ball
 ② Once upon a time → Gabriel Okara
 ③ A prayer for my daughter → W.B. Yeats
 ④ On his blindness → John Milton
 ⑤ Sweeney is round → Emily Dickinson
 sweetly

Prose.

- ① My lord the baby → Rabindranath Tagore
 ② Old love → Telling Archer
 ③ What I found in my pocket → Chesterton
 ④ The beauty Industry → Aldous Huxley
 ⑤ The little girl → Katherine Mansfield

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